



Day 3: NumPy Basics – The Foundation of AI & Data Science



Day Goal

By the end of Day 3, you should understand:

What NumPy is

Why it's faster than Python lists

Arrays

Indexing

Slicing

Basic Operations



What is NumPy?

NumPy (Numerical Python) is a Python library

used for numerical computing.

It provides a powerful data structure called ndarray (N-dimensional Array).

It is the foundation of:



Data Science



Machine Learning



Deep Learning



Data Analysis

Why NumPy Instead of Python Lists?

Python List	NumPy Array
Slower	Much Faster

More Memory	Less Memory
Limited Math Operations Example:	Powerful Vectorized Operations

```
numbers = [1,2,3]
```



NumPy:

```
import numpy as np  
numbers = np.array([1,2,3])
```





Creating Arrays



```
import numpy as np  
arr = np.array([1,2,3,4,5])  
print(arr)
```

Output



```
[1 2 3 4 5]
```



Array Dimensions

1D Array



```
arr = np.array([1,2,3])
```

2D Array



```
arr = np.array([ [1,2,3], [4,5,6] ])
```

Looks like a table.



Indexing

Access an element using its position.



```
arr = np.array([10,20,30]) print(arr[0])
```

Output



10

Second element



```
print(arr[1])
```

Output



20



Slicing

Get multiple elements.



```
arr = np.array([10,20,30,40,50])  
print(arr[1:4])
```

Output



```
[20 30 40]
```

Syntax



```
[start:end]
```

End index is not included.

+ Basic Operations

Addition

```
arr = np.array([1,2,3]) print(arr+5)
```



Output

```
[6 7 8]
```



Multiplication



```
print(arr*2)
```

Output



```
[2 4 6]
```

Square



```
print(arr**2)
```

Output



```
[1 4 9]
```

Useful Functions

Length



```
len(arr)
```

Maximum



```
arr.max()
```

Minimum

Sum

```
arr.sum()
```



Mean

```
arr.mean()
```



Real-Life Use Cases

NumPy is used for:

Image Processing 

AI Models 

Data Analysis 

Scientific Computing 

Computer Vision 

Neural Networks 



Practice Questions

Easy

1. Create an array of numbers from 1 to 5.
 2. Print the third element.
 3. Multiply every element by 10.
-

Medium

Create



```
[[1,2], [3,4]]
```

Then print only:



```
4
```

Challenge

Create



```
[10,20,30,40,50]
```

Print



[20 30 40]

without manually typing the output.



Interview Questions

Q1. What is NumPy?

Answer: NumPy is a Python library used for fast numerical computing. It provides the ndarray data structure, which is faster and more memory-efficient than Python lists.

Answer: NumPy stores elements of the same data type in contiguous memory and performs operations using optimized C code, making computations significantly faster.

Q3. What is an ndarray?

Answer: An ndarray is NumPy's core data structure used to store homogeneous (same data type) multi-dimensional arrays.

Q4. What is the difference between Indexing and Slicing?

Indexing retrieves a single element.

Slicing retrieves a range of elements.

Example:



```
arr[2] # Indexing arr[1:4] # Slicing
```



Day 3 Checklist

Install NumPy (pip install numpy)

Create a 1D array

Create a 2D array

Practice indexing

Practice slicing

Perform arithmetic operations

Solve the practice questions

Commit today's code to GitHub

Pro Tip

Many beginners think Pandas is the starting point for AI. In reality, NumPy is the mathematical foundation that libraries like Pandas, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, and PyTorch build upon. Spending one solid day understanding NumPy basics will make the rest of your AI journey much smoother.